The BFG

By Roald Dahl (Adapted by David Wood)

NOTE: This cutting asks each student to portray multiple characters, which is permissible for Nationals and SOME states. It may not meet the rules requirement for DUO in your state! Be sure to check your STATE rules before performing at local tournaments.

Suggested Roles:

ACTOR 1: *Narrator 1, Sophie, Bonecruncher, Gizzardgulper, Head of Air Force*

ACTOR 2: *Narrator 2; Mrs. Clonkers, BFG, Bloodbottler, Childchewer, Queen, Head of Army*

NARRATOR 1: **(Pg 17-20)** It was late at night. . .

NARRATOR 2: *(makes an owl hooting noise)*

NARRATOR 1: . . . in the orphanage dormitory, Sophie couldn't sleep. *(acting out the story as she tells it)* A brilliant moonbeam was shining right on to her pillow. She slipped out of bed to get a drink of water.

MRS. CLONKERS: Sophie! Back to bed this instant. You know the rules.

NARRATOR 1: Mrs Clonkers! Sophie went back to bed. She tried very hard to doze off. The time ticked by.

NARRATOR 2: *(makes the tick-tock noise)*

NARRATOR 1: The house was absolutely silent. Perhaps, thought Sophie, this is what they call the witching hour, that special moment in the middle of the night when everyone is in a deep, deep sleep, all the dark things come out from hiding and have the world to themselves. She crept to the window. And suddenly she saw. . . a giant. *(BFG enters in a cloak and carries a suitcase; he acts out the narration)* He stopped at the house opposite, bent down to look in a bedroom window and then . . .

BFG: *(BFG opens a suitcase, take out a jar and pour its contents into the end of a horn-like trumpet. Blows through it into an imaginary window. Turns and notices Sophie - Gasps)*

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NARRATOR 1: He saw Sophie. *(acting out the story as she tells it)* She pulled back from the window, flew across the dormitory and jumped into her bed and hid under the blanket, tingling all over.

BFG: *(Peeps in the window and with a growl, pushes a hand through and snatches SOPHIE, holding her up high)*

BOTH: Aaaaaaaah!

BFG: *(Begins slow-motion, on-the-spot running)*

NARRATOR 1: Running, striding, leaping through the night. Over fields, over hedges, over rivers, each stride as long as a tennis court. Faster, faster, feet scarcely touching the ground. Over oceans, over forests, over mountains . . .To a land unknown to human beings.

INTRODUCTION

ACTOR 1: *Sophie's life as an orphan is not exactly what dreams are made of.*
ACTOR 2: *That is until one night when a big friendly giant makes his way into town during the witching hour to blow dreams into the minds of sleeping children.*
ACTOR 1: *He whisks Sophie away to Giant Country. Why? Because humans can't know that Giants exist.*
ACTOR 2: *And it's there that the adventures begin.*
ACTOR 1: *The BFG isn't like the other Giants, who are not at all friendly.*
ACTOR 2: *Ultimately our hero, Sophie, with the help of the BFG and the Queen, saves the day and the children of England too!*
TOGETHER: *The BFG by Roald Dahl adapted by David Wood*

BFG: **(Pg 27-32)** *(Standing over SOPHIE)* Ha! What has us got here? *(He looks carefully at SOPHIE. At first, he should not appear very friendly)*

SOPHIE: *(Nervously)* Where am I?

BFG: This is my cave.

SOPHIE: Why did you snatch me and bring me here?

BFG: Because you ***saw*** me. If anyone is ever ***seeing*** a giant, he or she must be taken away hipswitch.

SOPHIE: Why?

BFG: Human beans is not ***believing*** in giants, is they? Human beans is not ***thinking*** giants exist.

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SOPHIE: I do.

BFG: Ah, but that is because you has ***seen*** me. If I hadn't snitched you, you would be scuddling around yodelling the news on the telly-telly bunkum box that you were actually ***seeing*** a giant, and then a great giant-hunt, a mighty giant look-see, would be starting up all over the world, and human beans would be trying to catch me and put me in the zoo with all those squiggling hippodumplings and crocadowndillies.

SOPHIE: So what's going to happen to me now? *(Gasping)* Please don't eat me!

BFG: *(Bellowing with laughter)* Just because I is a giant, you think I is a man-gobbling cannybull! No! You is lucky. If one of the other giants is snitching you, they is crunching you up for sure. Bones crackety-crackety-cracking. Gobble, gobbledy, gone!

SOPHIE: Other giants? You mean there are more of you?

BFG: Of course! This is Giant Country! *(He picks up SOPHIE)* Be peeping out over there, little girl, and be seeing a brain bogglingsome sight. *(They peep outside)*

SOPHIE: What on earth are they doing?

BFG: Nothing. They is just waiting for the night to come. Then they will be galloping off to places where human beans is living to find chiddlers to guzzle for their suppers.

SOPHIE: Where?

BFG: All over the world. That's the Bonecruncher. He is thinking Turkish chiddlers is juiciest chiddlers. They is tasting of Turkish delight!

SOPHIE: Of course. Who's that big, fierce one?

BFG: That's the Fleshlumpeater. He's fancying getting his chompers round a handful of chiddlers from Wellington! That's the Bloodbottler. He is thinking the English chiddlers is tasting ever so wonderfully of crodscollop.

SOPHIE: I'm not sure I know what that means.

BFG: Meanings is not important. You will be coming to an ucky-mucky end if any of them should ever be getting his gogglers upon you. You would be swallowed up like a piece of frumpkin pie, all in one dollop. *(They return inside the cave)* There. You is safe in here.

SOPHIE: **(Pg 33-35)** I think eating children is horrible.

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BFG: I has told you. I is not eating chiddlers. Not I! I is a freaky giant! I is a nice and jumbly giant! I is the BFG.

SOPHIE: The BFG?

BFG: The Big Friendly Giant! What is your name?

SOPHIE: My name is Sophie.

BFG: How is you doing, Sophie? *(He gently shakes hands with SOPHIE)* Your poor mother and father. By now they must be jipping and skumping all over the house shouting, 'Hallo, hallo, where is Sophie gone?'

SOPHIE: I don't have a mother and father. They died when I was a baby.

BFG: You is a norphan? Oh you poor little scrumplet. You is making me sad.

SOPHIE: Don't be sad. No one at the orphanage will be worrying much about me.

BFG: Was you happy there?

SOPHIE: I hated it. Mrs Clonkers locked me in the cellar once for not folding up my clothes.

BFG: The filthy old fizzwiggler! You is making me sadder than ever. *(he sobs)*

SOPHIE: Don't cry, BFG. Please. *(The BFG recovers a little)* Listen, we can't just sit here and let any more children be eaten. We've got to stop those brutes. It's up to us! We've got to save the children of the world!

BFG: Us? Redunculus and umpossible. *(He takes out a bottle of liquid)*

SOPHIE: **(Pg 52-55)** *(Reading from the bottle)* Frobscottle?

BFG: I drink it lots. Delumptious, fizzy frobscottle! *(He removes the stopper. There is a fizzing sound)*

SOPHIE: Hey, look! It's fizzing the wrong way! In our fizzy drinks, like Coke and Pepsi, the bubbles go upwards.

BFG: Flushbunking rubbsquash! Upgoing bubbles is a catasterous disastrophe.

SOPHIE: But why?

BFG: Listen. When you is drinking this cokey drink of yours, it is going straight down into your tummy. And the bubbles is going also into your tummy. If the bubbles is fizzing upwards,

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they will all come swishwiffing up your throat and out of your mouth and make a foulsome belchy burp!

SOPHIE: That's often true. But what's wrong with a little burp now and again? It's sort of fun.

BFG: Burping is filthsome. Us giants is never doing it.

SOPHIE: But with ***your*** drink. . .

BFG: Frobscottle.

SOPHIE: With frobscottle, the bubbles in your tummy will be going downwards and that could have a far nastier result. They'll be coming out some where else with an even louder and ruder noise.

BFG: A whizzpopper! Us giants is making whizzpoppers all the time! Whizzpopping is a sign of happiness. It is music in our ears!

SOPHIE: But it's. . . it's rude!

BFG: But you is whizzpopping, is you not, now and again?

SOPHIE: Everyone is . . . whizzpopping. Kings and queens, even little babies. But where I come from, it's not polite to talk about it.

BFG: Redunculous! If everyone is making whizzpoppers, then why not talk about it? Now, let's be having a swiggle and seeing the result! *(The BFG drinks from the bottle. Pauses. Then ecstasy fills his face. A very loud whizzpopper nearly shoots him in the air)* Whoopee! *(And another)* Wheeeeeeee! *(SOPHIE laughs, in spite of herself)* Have some. Go on. It's gloriumptious!

SOPHIE: It's lovely. *(Suddenly a succession of whizzpoppers – Sophie giggles)* Wheee! Wheeeeee! *(suddenly a roar of the other giants startles them)*

BLOODBOTTLER: **(Pg 76-78)** 'Tis the witchy hour. And I is starveling!

BONECRUNCHER: Let us go guzzle human beans! *(Both cheer)*

CHILDCHEWER: Let us fluchbunk to England!

GIZZARDGULPER: I is fancying a few nice little English chiddlers! *(Both cheer)*

SOPHIE: We've got to stop them. We must warn everyone in England they're coming!

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BFG: Redunculus and ***um***-possiple. I is never showing myself to human beans. They will be putting me in the zoo with all the jiggyraffes and cattypiddlers. And they will be sending you straight back to the norpahage. Grown-ups is all squifflerotters and grinksludgers.

SOPHIE: *(thinking)* I've got it! Listen, BFG, we'll go to the Queen and tell her about the giants. She'll do something, I know she will.

******Buckingham Palace*******

QUEEN: **(Pg 107)** *(Fanfare. Enter the Queen)* It's been a rough morning. **(Pg 106)** Sophie, you have told me of your visit to Giant Country and of the giants' ghastly night-time children-eating raids. *(she claps her hands)* **(Pg 108-109)** Summon the Head of the Army and the Head of the Air Force immediately*! (they enter)* Good morning, gentleman. You've read about the disappearing children? *(pause)* They were eaten. *(pause)* By giants.

HO AIR FORCE: Giants?

HO ARMY: No such fellas, Your Majesty.

HO AIRFORCE: Except in fairy-tales. *(Both laugh)*

QUEEN: **(Pg 110-112)** Gentleman, allow me to present the Big Friendly Giant. *(she indicates behind them)*

BOTH: *(turn; see the BFG)* Aaaaaah! *(cling to one another in terror)* A giant!

QUEEN: Indeed. Luckily a friendly one. His colleagues are not. Tonight those bloodthirsty brutes will be galloping off to gobble up [more] unfortunate wretches. They have to be stopped. Fast. They must be brought back. Alive.

HO AIR FORCE: Alive? They'd knock us down like ninepins!

BFG: Keep your skirts on! I has the answer. Every afternoon all these giants is lying on the ground snoozling in the Land of Noddy. All you has to do is creep up on them and tie them up.

HO AIR FORCE: But how do we get the brutes back here?

BFG: You is having belly poppers, is you not?

HO AIR FORCE: Are you being rude? *(BFG lets loose with a wizzpopper)*

SOPHIE: *(with a disapproving look to BFG)* He means helicopters.

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